

BABIANA

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IRIDACEAE

Genus of mainly spring-flowering cormous perennials with lance-shaped leaves, valued for their brightly colored, funnel-shaped flowers, which are somewhat like freesias. Requires a position in sun and well-drained soil. Propagate in fall by seed or natural division of corms.

B. disticha. See *B. fragrans*.

B. fragrans, syn. *B. disticha*, *B. plicata*. Spring-flowering corm. H 4–8in (10–20cm), S 2–3in (5–8cm). Has a fan of hairy, erect, basal leaves and short spikes of scented violet-blue flowers, with yellow-patched petals. Z13–15 (min. 41°F/5°C)

B. plicata. See *B. fragrans*.

B. rubrocyanea (Winecups) illus. p.418.

B. stricta. Spring-flowering corm. H 4–8in (10–20cm), S 2–3in (5–8cm). Produces a fan of hairy, erect, basal leaves and short spikes of up to 10 purple, blue, cream, or yellow flowers, sometimes red-centered. Z13–15 (min. 41°F/5°C)

BACCHARIS

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of mainly fall-flowering evergreen or deciduous shrubs and herbaceous perennials, grown for their foliage and fruits. Useful for exposed, coastal gardens and dry soil. Requires a position in full sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer.

B. halimifolia (Bush groundsel). Vigorous, deciduous, bushy shrub. H and S 12ft (4m). Ovate leaves are gray-green, and sharply toothed. Large clusters of tiny, white flower heads in midfall precede fluffy, white heads of tiny fruits. Z3–7

Baculellum articulatum. See *Curio articulata*.

Bahia lanata. See *Eriophyllum lanatum*.

BALLOTA

LAMIACEAE/LABIATAE

Genus of perennials and evergreen or deciduous subshrubs, grown for their foliage and flowers. Requires very well-drained soil and full sun. Cut back in spring before growth starts. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer.

B. acetabulosa illus. p.165.

B. pseudodictamnus illus. p.347.

BAMBUSA

POACEAE/GRAMINEAE

See also GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES, and SEDGES.

B. glaucescens. See *B. multiplex*.

B. multiplex, syn. *B. glaucescens* (Hedge bamboo). Evergreen bamboo. H 10–50ft (3–15m), S indefinite. Produces slender, arching canes with narrow leaves, 4–6in (10–15cm) long. Useful for a hedge or windbreak. Z8–11

BANKSIA

PROTEACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs and trees, grown for their flowers and foliage. Requires full light and sharply drained, sandy soil that contains few phosphates or nitrates. Water containerized plants moderately when in full growth, sparingly at other times. Freely ventilate plants grown under glass. Propagate by seed in spring.

B. baxteri. Evergreen, spreading, open shrub. H and S 6–10ft (2–3m). Leathery, mid-green leaves are strap-shaped, cut from the midrib into triangular, sharply pointed lobes. Produces dense, spherical heads of small, tubular, yellow flowers in summer. Z10–11

B. coccinea illus. p.456.

B. ericifolia (Heath banksia). Evergreen, irregularly rounded, wiry, freely branching shrub. H 10–20ft (3–6m), S 6–12ft (2–4m). Has small, needlelike leaves and dense, upright, bottlebrushlike spikes, each 8in (20cm) long, of small, tubular, bronze-red or yellow flowers in fall or winter. Z10–11

B. serrata. Evergreen shrub or tree of bushy habit. H 10–70ft (3–20m), S 5–25ft (1.5–8m). Oblong to lance-shaped, saw-toothed, leathery leaves are mid- to deep green. Small, tubular, reddish-budded, cream flowers are borne in dense, upright, bottlebrushlike spikes, 4–6in (10–15cm) long, from summer to late fall. Z10–11

BAPTISIA

PAPILIONACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE

Genus of summer-flowering perennials, grown for their flowers. Requires full sun and well-drained, preferably sandy soil. Best left undisturbed once planted. Propagate by division in early spring or by seed in fall.

B. australis (False indigo) illus. p.240.

Barbacenia elegans. See *Vellozia elegans*.

BARLERIA

ACANTHACEAE

Genus of evergreen perennials and shrubs, grown for their flowers. Needs full light or partial shade and fertile soil. Water containerized plants well when in full growth, moderately at other times. In the growing season, prune tips of young plants to encourage branching. For a more compact habit, shorten long stems after flowering. Can be propagated by seed in spring or by greenwood or semiripe cuttings in summer.

B. cristata (Philippine violet). Evergreen, semierect shrub. H 3–4ft (1–1.2m), S 18–28in (45–70cm). Has elliptic, coarsely haired leaves. Tubular, light violet flowers, sometimes pale pink or white, are borne from upper leaf axils in summer. Z10–11 (min. 50°F/10°C)

B. obtusa. Evergreen, erect, spreading shrub. H and S to 3ft (1m). Leaves are elliptic. Tubular, mauve flowers are produced from upper leaf axils in winter–spring. Z9–12 (min. 50°F/10°C)

Barosma pulchella. See *Agathosma pulchella*.

Bartonia aurea. See *Mentzelia lindleyi*.

BARTLETTINA

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of small evergreen trees and shrubs, grown mainly for their flowers, some also for their architectural foliage. Needs full light or partial shade. Will grow in any conditions, although most species prefer moist but well-drained soil. Water containerized plants freely when in full growth, moderately at other times. Prune shrubs lightly after flowering or in spring. Propagate by seed in spring; can be propagated by softwood or greenwood cuttings in summer. Red spider mite and whitefly may be troublesome.

B. sordida, syn. *Eupatorium ianthinum*, *E. sordidum*. Evergreen, rounded, robust-stemmed shrub. H 6–10ft (2–3m), S 5–8ft (1.5–2.5m). Ovate, serrated, deep green leaves are red-haired. Produces fragrant, pomponlike, violet-purple flower heads in flattened clusters, mainly in winter. Z13–15 (min. 50°F/10°C)

BASSIA

SYN. KOCHIA

AMARANTHACEAE/CHENOPODIACEAE

Genus of annuals and perennials, grown for their habit, the feathery effect of their leaves, and their fall tints. Does best in sun and in fertile, well-drained soil. May require support in very windy areas. Propagate by seed sown under glass in early to mid-spring, or outdoors in late spring.

B. scoparia f. trichophylla, syn. *Kochia trichophylla* (Burning bush, Summer cypress), illus. p.316.

BAUERA

CUNONIACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs, grown mainly for their flowers. Needs full sun and humus-rich, well-drained, neutral to acidic soil. Water potted plants moderately, less when not in full growth. Remove straggly stems after flowering. Propagate by seed sown in spring or by semiripe cuttings taken in late summer.

B. rubioides. Evergreen, bushy, wiry-stemmed shrub, usually of spreading habit. H 6in–10ft (15cm–3m) S 2–10ft (60cm–3m). Leaves each have 3 ovate to lance-shaped, glossy leaflets. Bowl-shaped, pink or white flowers are borne in early spring and summer. Z13–15 (min. 37–41°F/3–5°C)

BAUHINIA

CAESALPINIACEAE

Genus of evergreen or deciduous trees, shrubs and perennial climbers, grown mainly for their orchidlike flowers. Requires full light and fertile, well-drained soil. Water containerized specimens freely when in full growth, less in winter. Thin out congested growth after flowering. Propagate by seed in spring.

B. galpinii, syn. *B. punctata*. Evergreen, spreading shrub, occasionally semi-

climbing. H 6–10ft (2–3m), S 3–10ft (1–3m). Has 2-lobed leaves and, in summer, bears fragrant, bright brick-red flowers. Z13–15 (min. 45°F/7°C)

B. punctata. See *B. galpinii*.

B. variegata illus. p.450. ‘*Candida*’ is a deciduous tree, rounded when young, spreading with age. H 6ft (2m), S 10ft (3m). Has broadly ovate, deeply notched leaves and fragrant, pure white flowers, 4in (10cm) across, in winter–spring or sometimes later. Z13–15 (min. 45°F/7°C)

BEAUCARNEA

ASPARAGACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs and trees, grown mainly for their intriguing overall appearance. Needs full light and sharply drained, fertile soil; tolerates drought conditions. Water container plants moderately; between each watering, allow potting medium to almost dry out. Propagate by seed or root offsets in spring.

B. recurvata, syn. *Nolina recurvata*, *N. tuberculata* (Elephant’s foot, Pony-tail), illus. p.451.

BEAUMONTIA

APOCYNACEAE

Genus of evergreen, woody-stemmed, twining climbers, grown for their large, fragrant flowers and handsome leaves. Needs fertile, well-drained soil and full light. In growing season, water freely, sparingly at other times. Provide support. Thin out previous season’s growth after flowering. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in late summer.

B. grandiflora (Herald’s trumpet) illus. p.459.

BEGONIA

BEGONIACEAE

Genus of evergreen or deciduous shrubs and small, tree-like plants, perennials and annuals. Grown for their colorful flowers and/or ornamental leaves. Prefers slightly acidic soil. Susceptible to powdery mildew and botrytis from late spring to early fall. Commonly cultivated begonias are divided into the following groupings, each with varying cultivation requirements. See also feature panel p.317.

Cane-stemmed begonias

Evergreen, woody perennials, many known as “Angelwings,” with usually erect, canelike stems bearing regularly spaced, swollen nodes and flowers in large, pendulous panicles. Encourage branching by pinching out growing tips. New growth develops from base of plant. Grow under glass in good light but not direct sun (poor light reduces quantity of flowers) and in free-draining, loam-based potting mix. Stake tall plants. Propagate in spring by seed or tip cuttings.

Rex-cultorum begonias

Mostly evergreen, rhizomatous perennials of variable habit derived from crosses of *B. rex* and related species. Grown for their brilliantly colored, ovate to lance-shaped leaves, 3–12in (8–30cm) long, that are sometimes spirally twisted. Prefers 40–75% relative humidity. Grow